



HI NGE SIYANI

Building Together. Rising Together.

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"We are not leaving each other behind."

PROJECT PORTFOLIO

Sonke Hackathon Submission — Limpopo Co-Design/Create Challenge

Challenge Track: Smart Service Delivery for Rural & Underserved Communities

MAD HALO Technologies

July 2026

IMPORTANT

About This Submission

*This document and the accompanying prototype represent a hackathon-stage build. The Chat experience currently uses a **scripted guidance engine** — pre-written responses to common questions — to reliably demonstrate the intended user experience under demo conditions. **Live, open-ended AI reasoning is planned as the next development phase**, not yet part of this build. Every feature in this document is labelled **Working**, **In Progress**, or **Coming Soon** — nothing here is claimed as complete unless it demonstrably is.*

We believe this transparency is a strength, not a weakness: it shows a team that understands exactly where its product stands and what it takes to move forward.

THE PROBLEM

Opportunity in South Africa Is Scattered, Not Scarce

Bursaries, funding, TVET pathways, and government services exist — but they live behind dozens of disconnected websites, offices, and queues. Most digital services assume English fluency, sidelining citizens who think and transact in another official language. Search engines return links, not a plan tailored to a person's age, province, and life stage. In rural and underserved communities specifically, these barriers compound: limited data, limited digital literacy, and services designed for urban, English-first users.

The cost isn't just inconvenience — it's bursaries missed, businesses never registered, and services never claimed.

THE SOLUTION

Siyani — One Trusted Conversation

Siyani is a multilingual AI companion that gets to know a person once, then helps them navigate education, government services, and — eventually — every other life area, as one continuous relationship instead of separate apps.

- Understands who you are: age, province, status, goals
- Speaks your language — 5 today, built to grow to all 11
- Turns a conversation into a personalised action plan
- Asks for clarification instead of guessing when uncertain

THE VISION

One Ecosystem Across Every Stage of Life

Domain	Status
Education	Working (MVP)
Government Services	Working (MVP)
Employment	Coming Soon
Finance	Coming Soon
Healthcare Information	Coming Soon
Entrepreneurship Support	Coming Soon
Community Opportunities	Coming Soon

USER JOURNEY

From First Hello to a Personal Action Plan

1. Welcome

Logo intro, then language selection in English, isiZulu, Sepedi, Tshivenda, or Xitsonga.

2. Onboarding

Name, surname, age, province, and current status — collected once, in the user's chosen language.

3. Secure Account

A randomly generated password (never derived from personal data) and explicit Privacy Policy consent.

4. Guided Plan

Siyani surfaces guidance across Education and Government Services, with more life areas Coming Soon.

TECHNOLOGY

Built to Demo This Week, Built to Scale After

Layer	Technology
Client (Android)	Delphi 12 FMX
Auth & Structured Data	Supabase (PostgreSQL + Auth)
Real-time & Notifications	Firebase Realtime Database
Networking	REST APIs via TNetHTTPClient
Version Control	Git + GitHub
Future AI Services	Python (Coming Soon)

Chosen to match the founding team's current, real experience — realistic to build within the hackathon window, with a clear path to Flutter (cross-platform), Web, and iOS in later phases.

LANGUAGE & TRUST

Knowing What You Don't Know, in Five Languages

English and isiZulu have strong AI language support today. Sepedi, Tshivenda, and Xitsonga are earlier in that curve. Rather than guessing and risking a wrong answer, Siyani is designed to recognise uncertainty and ask a clarifying question instead — turning a technical limitation into a visible product value: Siyani is honest, not just fluent.

PRIVACY & SECURITY

Privacy Isn't a Feature — It's the Foundation

Minimal by design — Only information needed to give useful guidance is collected.

Consent first — Information is stored only after explicit user agreement.

Random password generation — Passwords are never derived from name, age, or personal data.

User-controlled deletion — Anyone can request full deletion of their data at any time.

POPIA-aligned — Built around South Africa's Protection of Personal Information Act from day one.

Never sold — Personal information is never sold or shared for advertising.

BUSINESS MODEL

Revenue That Grows With Impact

Stream	Description
Government & municipality licensing	Official digital-services companion for provinces & agencies
Institutional subscriptions	Schools, universities, and public institutions
NGO / donor-funded deployments	Community-focused rollouts
Corporate Social Investment (CSI)	Partnership-funded expansion
Premium SME services	AI business guidance, funding readiness, compliance support
Anonymous insights dashboards	For municipalities & development orgs — no personal data sold

The core citizen version remains free to ensure accessibility.

THE ASK

What We Need to Move From Prototype to Pilot

We're a small founding team building lean. This ask is scoped to close the specific gap between a working hackathon demo and a stable, testable release — not a full commercial-scale budget.

Investment	What It Covers
R2,300	Apple + Google Play developer accounts — required to legally publish on both stores
~R30,000	A MacBook — required for Delphi to build and deploy the iOS version (via PAServer)
~R2,000–R5,000/month	Cloud hosting (Supabase + Firebase) as usage scales beyond free tier
~R3,000–R8,000/month	Speech-to-text API costs, once voice interaction is built (Phase 2)
Mentorship + introductions	Access to provincial digital-services and education stakeholders
Part-time collaborators	1–2 people, brought on as the project grows past solo capacity

We're open to discussing scope at any tier — from covering just the developer accounts to a fuller package that includes hardware and mentorship. What matters most to us is the introductions and guidance that help this reach real communities.

Note on research partnerships: whether organisations such as SADiLaR, CText, or Lelapa AI would collaborate on a funded or in-kind basis is not yet confirmed — we are approaching these conversations openly, without assuming free support, and will update this ask as those discussions develop.

RESEARCH ROADMAP

Partnership Targets for Multilingual Voice

Voice interaction is Coming Soon, and we see it as a partnership opportunity rather than something to build alone. South Africa already has active language-technology research relevant to Siyani's mission:

- **SADiLaR** (South African Centre for Digital Language Resources) — government-funded, hosted at North-West University, builds digital resources for South Africa's official languages.
- **CText** (Centre for Text Technology, North-West University) — NLP and speech research for South African languages.
- **Lelapa AI** — a South African startup building AI specifically for African languages.

We intend to approach these organisations once past the hackathon stage, with the goal of building genuinely accurate multilingual voice support rather than a rushed approximation.

OUR STORY

Why HI NGE SIYANI Exists

HI NGE SIYANI was co-founded with Ntsikelelo Mkalipi, growing out of a belief shared from our own community: opportunity is too often about who you know, not what you know. We saw capable, motivated young people in our township miss out — not from lack of ability, but from lack of access and information.

What began as a youth empowerment initiative is growing into something broader. Alongside Ntsikelelo, we are in the process of registering HI NGE SIYANI as a non-profit company, supported by an emerging advisory board. While young people remain central to this mission, our vision extends to our whole community — helping every person feel recognised and assisted in the language they actually speak.

WHY THIS, WHY NOW

A Note From the Founder

HI NGE SIYANI is built by MAD HALO Technologies, a software and digital transformation studio based in Limpopo. This project grew out of a simple, personal observation: in the communities I come from, the opportunities meant for people are often technically available, but practically out of reach — buried in English-only forms, scattered across offices, and disconnected from the language people actually think in.

I've built software before — from ride-hailing apps to school management platforms — but this project is the first aimed directly at the gap I've seen most often: people who are capable and motivated, but locked out by information, not ability. Building Siyani, on the technology I know best, is my way of proving this idea works before asking anyone else to believe in it too.

ROADMAP

From Hackathon Prototype to National Platform

Phase	Focus
Phase 1 — MVP (current)	Education + Government Services, 5 languages, Delphi Android app
Phase 2 — Expansion (Coming Soon)	Finance & Healthcare guidance, Reminder Centre, Flutter rebuild
Phase 3 — Platform (Coming Soon)	Full 11-language, 7-domain ecosystem across Web, iOS & Android

TEAM

Built by MAD HALO Technologies

A South African software and digital transformation studio, currently building this project solo, with the intention to grow the team as the project moves past the hackathon stage.

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